

SOMETHING LESS THAN THE WHOLE

01x02 - "Fix Your Hearts or Die"

Written by

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To David Lynch, the best to ever do it

OPEN ON:

Grey sky over the empty, wet streets of Chesterfield.

MARK (V.O.)

They say the only way is forward.
They say nothing good can ever come
of looking back.

(a beat)

I never looked back.

JOSH (17), surrounded by a dense black fog clutching on his limbs, terrified looks into camera.

MARK (V.O.) (CONT'D)

Is my soul anything anymore? Is my
heart nothing but a gangrenous
muscle?

CHRIS wakes up in his bed. Eyes pop wide open. On his door hangs the RED AND YELLOW uniform of Chesterfield High.

OPENING CREDITS: "SOMETHING LESS THAN THE WHOLE - FIX YOUR HEARTS OR DIE"

EXT. INLAND CAFÉ - DAY

EDGAR sits alone at the table outside the café. The cold breeze smokes the cigarette he is absently holding. Ashes blow on the table.

From the window, we see Monica busy behind the counter. She's collecting and labelling supplies, when she notices Edgar. She walks to the door with an inquisitive look on her face.

She opens the door and Edgar turns to her. She stays on the edge of the door as they talk.

MONICA

Edgar!

EDGAR

It's almost eight thirty young
lady.

Monica doesn't compute and exits the café completely.

MONICA

I'm not opened today.

EDGAR

It's Friday.

MONICA
It's The Games, Edgar.

EDGAR
The Games?

MONICA
Yes, Edgar. The Games.

EDGAR
Since when is that circus a good
excuse not to work?

MONICA
I am working. Can't you see?

Monica gestures to the counter, which Edgar peeps over
perplexed. He shakes in head in disappointment.

MONICA (CONT'D)
What?

Edgar lets his, at this point dead, cigarette fall to the
ground and stands up.

EDGAR
When I was a kid - those were The
Games. Collaboration, initiative,
danger. They made us though. They
made us strong. Luke - no. Yes.
Thomas Crewly picked me up and
slammed me down so hard at the
Senior Games, I was in a wheelchair
at my graduation. In a wheelchair,
I tell you. Mind you, I finished
The Games. Walked out on my own
legs. They wouldn't allow it now.

MONICA
Maybe they shouldn't have allowed
it back then either.

Edgar looks down at his own shoes and mumbles something
indecipherable.

MONICA (CONT'D)
What did you say?

EDGAR
Enjoy the circus, young lady.

The man walks away, leaving a certain sadness on Monica's
face. She picks up Edgar's cigarette butt from the ground
and heads back inside.

INT. MONTAGE

We see various people of Chesterfield in front of their mirrors getting ready for The Games, putting on their UNIFORMS.

The boys and the girls wear the same clothing: white shirt, red sleeveless sweater with yellow embroidery, jacket with the Chesterfield High logo over the heart. The only difference is the girls have skirts and the boys pants.

We see, rapidly:

- TARA, worried
- CHELSEA, smiling
- ROSE, determined
- DANIEL, content
- JAMES, satisfied
- CHRIS, emotionless
- LEAH, fixing her hair and blowing a kiss at herself

THEN

- LEWIS, dressed in casual clothes, somewhat mischievous look in his eyes
- JEFF, wearing a cleaned up, black version of the tracksuit he wore in the PILOT

ULTIMATELY

- MARK, fixing his buckle, throwing on his watch.

We stay on Mark as..

INT. MARK'S APARTMENT - DAY

Mark walks in the living room. Picks up car keys and jacket from the table and walks out. CAMERA ROTATES to follow Mark from the bedroom to the front door, finally REVEALING the STATIC on his TV.

EXT. MARK'S BUILDING - CONTINUOUS

Mark comes out of the building, but immediately stops.

MARK

The fuck are you doing here?

ROSENTHAL
We have to talk.

Rosenthal is sitting on the hood of Mark's car smoking, looking tired, underslept.

MARK
No. We don't.

Mark goes to the car and puts the key in the lock.

MARK (CONT'D)
Move.

ROSENTHAL
Why did you pass it on?

MARK
I already explained it to you.

ROSENTHAL
Oh no you didn't. You gave me the
"she was too drunk" bullshit and I
don't buy it. You think they do?

MARK
Is that what this is? They sent you
of all people to interrogate me?

Mark notices a woman walking her dog down the street.

MARK (CONT'D)
Would you look at that? Am I also
being surveilled now?

Rosenthal looks over to the woman.

ROSENTHAL
What? Maybe. I don't fucking know.

MARK
Are we done?

ROSENTHAL
It's a bit early for The Games.

MARK
I'm help- Actually, fuck you. I
have shit to do.

ROSENTHAL
It's so sweet of you to help her
out. Really.

Mark doesn't react and enters the car, slamming the door behind him.

He starts the car and Rosenthal throws her cigarette to the ground next to it.

As the car backs up, Rosenthal cheekily smiles and waves at Mark, but, as soon as she feels out of sight, she lets go of a quite deep cough.

EXT. CHESTERFIELD HIGH - DAY

It's finally time for THE GAMES.

A big banner hangs in front of the school saying: "WELCOME TO THE 47TH CHESTERFIELD GAMES".

Families and people of all ages joyously enter the gates of the school and head for the football field behind the school.

Between all the people crossing the gates, we also see LEWIS. He's all alone.

INT. GYM - CHESTERFIELD HIGH - SAME TIME

The students are gathered on the stands, boys sit on one side, girls on the other. Chris is with Daniel and James, looking a bit lost. Tara, next to Rose and Chelsea peeps over Leah and Toni a couple of rows ahead of her.

Principal Lawler stands in front of them in a fresh black suit with Jeff by his side.

Chatter and excitement fill the room.

LAWLER
SILENCE PLEASE!

The students obey right away.

LAWLER (CONT'D)
Thank you.
(a beat)
Welcome everybody and thank you for being here on this joyous occasion. This is the forty-seventh edition of The Games. Forty-seven times our community has gathered to celebrate you. Our youth. Our tomorrow's best. It's on these days that we are reminded of the ancillary role of unity, courage and strength.
(MORE)

LAWLER (CONT'D)

As always, there will be some winners and there will be some losers, but most of all, there will be pain. Pain in your spirit, pain in your bones, pain in the hearts of those who love you. Your parents, your friends, your loved ones. It is through that pain that our resilience is forced. Like rustless steel forged from the fire of an indomitable flame. The Games. For some you this will be the first year competing, it will be last for some others and others again never have and never will compete, nonetheless, all of you make up for the fabric from which our champions will be untethered. Good luck everybody. And Remember.

(a beat)

Don't fall prey to the fear out there. The lights are brighter only for those who dare to elevate themselves above the herd.

The student and teacher erupt in a thunderous applause.

We catch Chris applauding, while he seems to be indeed falling prey to the fear.

Jeff waits for the applause to naturally wane.

JEFF

Very well. Just a quick word. You know the rules, they are the same as always. Two teams, three flags, bring your flags back, smack 'em down if they take yours. No punching, no kicking, no slapping, no biting et cetera et cetera, BUT, a little change HAS been implemented. An exciting dive in our shared tradition, a rush from the past if you will.

He takes a beat, taking in (and enjoying) the students' suspense.

He grins.

JEFF (CONT'D)

I'm bringing back full-court chases.

Bafflement sparks between the students.

STUDENT #1
The fuck?

STUDENT #2
There's no way.

JEFF
Any questions?

A very young student raises his hand in the first row.

JEFF (CONT'D)
(pointing at him)
Yes?

STUDENT #3
Why?

Jeff deviously smile.

JEFF
Well, why not?

A layer of silence covers the stands.

Jeff claps.

JEFF (CONT'D)
Come on. Hush hush. Get out there.
They are waiting for you.

As the students leave the gym in the most disorderly fashion, Lawler approaches Jeff.

LAWLER
Are you sure this is a good idea?

JEFF
You are the one that wanted to
bring back the true spirit of The
Games.

EXT. GAMES FIELD - DAY

CAMERA PANS around the football field. A smaller rectangle, with his own proportionate end-zones, has been drawn inside of it.

THREE FLAGS, YELLOW on one side and RED on the other, are positioned in each end-zone.

The stands cover one long and one short side of the field, while on the other long side there's a series of food stands and on the other short side is a tent with benches and tables.

People gather all around, as clouds of smoke blow from behind the food stands.

They all look professional, clean, ready to go, until the last one, which kind of looks put together at the last minute, maybe because it was. Its hand-drawn sign says "INLAND-TO-GO".

We follow to the back of that stand where... MONICA is setting up her operation.

She got coffee, she got burgers, greens, tomatoes, cheese, bacon, sauces, hotdogs, buns, beers, everything.

Mark approaches from the side carrying a HUGE bag of shredded potatoes over one shoulder and GALLONS of frying oil in the other end.

MARK

Where do you want this?

MONICA

(looking around)

That's a very good question.

MARK

Are you sure you can handle it all on your own?

MONICA

It's fine. Chris is gonna help me out once he's out. Tara might also borrow a hand. Her mom, Jessica, you've met her, said she's probably gonna help as well.

MARK

That's a lot of conditional phrases.

MONICA

Life is conditional, what can you do?

MARK

Monica, I wouldn't mind helping.

MONICA

You really want to help eh?

MARK

Yes.

MONICA

You can help me set up all this
shit then.

MARK

Isn't that why I'm here already?

MONICA

Yes. But we gotta hurry, I want to
see the opening.

Monica and Mark start unpacking stuff from the various boxes
they brought.

INT. CORRIDOR - GAMES FIELD - LATER

The school band leads the centipede of students behind them.
They all wait there. Dangling over the wolf's maw, some
spasmodically impatient, some shaking inadvertently.

Within the crowd, we find Chris trying to squish and squeeze
his way to Tara, who is a little ahead of him.

CHRIS

Sorry. Excuse me.

STUDENT #4

Bro. Be careful.

STUDENT #5

Fuck are you going dude?

He finally reaches Tara. Gently taps on her shoulder. She
turns around.

CHRIS

Hey.

TARA

Hey.

CHRIS

How you feelin'?

TARA

Good.

CHRIS

That's great.

She nods awkwardly. He doesn't know what to say. CHELSEA and ROSE shoots darts at him from her eyes.

CHRIS (CONT'D)
Full-court chases, eh? That's gonna
be rough.

TARA
Yeah.

ANNOUNCER (O.S.)
Ladies and gentlemen please take
your sit or standing. The Games are
about to begin.

CHRIS
I hate this, T.

TARA
What?

CHRIS
Come on. We haven't talked in a
week. It's weird.

ROSE
Should have thought about this
earlier maybe.

TARA
Rose.

CHELSEA
She's right tho.

Tara points somewhere on her side.

TARA
See over there?

Chris looks around too find LEAH, who is trying to make it
seem like she wasn't just staring at them.

TARA (CONT'D)
I don't think she would appreciate
this too much.

BAND MEMBER #1
GET READY!

BAND MEMBER #2
IN POSITION! WE GO IN
(MORE)

BAND MEMBER #2 (CONT'D)
 (the corridor fall
 silent)
 5...4...3...2...

ANNOUNCER (O.S.)
 Ladies and gentlemen! You forty-
 seventh Games Participants! The
 students of Chesterfield High!

The band starts playing loud and energetic, while leading the way out. We follow them as we transition into...

EXT. GAMES FIELD - CONTINUOUS

The stands are full, the sides of the fields are filling up, people cheer and jump and scream. It's palpable, it's electric, but it's also absurd. These are kids.

Chris is a bit swallowed by the all of it and, by the time he tries to catch up on Tara, she is already gone with the flow.

The kids dispose themselves over The Games field, all behind the band who keeps on leading the charge of the Chesterfield faithfuls.

The band members take a step in unison and the music stop. The cheering continues, grows louder.

The teacher emerge from the corridor, lead once again by Lawler and Jeff, who is holding a microphone.

As they circumnavigate the field to get behind the students we sneak to...

EXT. STANDS - SAME TIME

Lewis is sitting alone, looking down at the field with the eyes of a man who is experiencing extreme cultural shock. It all makes sense to them and it's at the same time so alien to him.

ANNOUNCER
 Ladies and Gentlemen please welcome
 Principal Lawler and the teaching
 staff of Chesterfield High.

People cheer, again. Of course.

As Lewis tries to make sense of the whole Games situation, a woman wearing a black hoodie, who is walking up the stands bumps into him and drops something from her cup on his shoulder.

WOMAN

Oh my God, I'm so sorry.

Lewis looks up at her. It's DEE. She has a bit of an empty look in her eyes. The mascara is not well done and drips from the corner of her eyes.

LEWIS

(smiling)

It's okay. Don't worry.

Dee closes her eyes and shakes her head. She almost starts crying.

DEE

I'm such a mess. I'm really really sorry.

LEWIS

Don't worry. It's fine. Enjoy your day.

Dee tries to conjure a smile.

DEE

Thank you.

LEWIS

Of course.

Dee continues up the stands.

Lewis smells something weird. It's coming from his shoulder.

He sniffles around it.

LEWIS (CONT'D)

Geez. At this time already?

EXT. MONICA'S STAND - SAME TIME

In the background, Jeff is giving the opening speech. Meanwhile, Monica's stand is almost up and running. Everything is almost in order and a pot of steaming hot coffee is on the counter, ready to be served.

On one side of the stand, Mark is getting vegetables into the appropriate trays and on the other Monica is pouring the frying oil, when...

RACHEL
Are you open?

Mark neck snaps. Monica turns to Rachel smiling.

MONICA
Oh my God! Rachel! It's so nice to
see you!

Monica drops what she was doing and goes to counter to greet Rachel.

JEFF (O.C.)
It will be though.

MONICA
Did you stumble here by chance or
did Tara tell you?

RACHEL
It was mum actually. She can't make
it.

MONICA
Oh. That's unfortunate.

JEFF (O.C.)
But we wouldn't want it any other
way.

QUICKLY on Mark who is trying to eavesdrop on Monica and Rachel.

MONICA
Are you sure you don't mind?

RACHEL
I'm sure Mon'.

MONICA
You are such a sweetheart. Please
come around, I'll show you.

Rachel walks to the around the stand. Monica seems excited.

MARK
Who is she?

MONICA
You are gonna like her, trust me.

Rachel walks in from the back.

MONICA (CONT'D)
Rachel, this is my friend Mark.
Mark this is Rachel, she is Tara's
sister.

RACHEL
Also a friend.

MONICA
A very good one.

JEFF (O.C.)
It is the face of doubt...

MARK
(extending his hand)
Very nice to meet you.

JEFF (O.C.)
...that we show our true colors.

RACHEL
(reciprocates, smiling)
Nice to meet you too, Mark.

MONICA
Shit.

MARK
What?

JEFF (O.C.)
LET THE GAMES BEGIN!!!

Thunderous applause, the band starts playing.

From the stand POV we see the students rushing back into the
corridor, leaving only TWELVE of them behind.

The band keeps playing as the kid distribute over two teams.
We follow into the field...

EXT. GAMES FIELD - CONTINUOUS

Jeff distributes red bibs to one team and yellow to the
other.

The students are young, too young for this.

Jeff steps out of the field and pulls a whistle out of his
pocket. He puts it around his neck. The students put on
their bibs take their positions on the field.

Tension grows. Chatter becomes more scattered. We survey the kids faces. Some are terrified, some play arrogant.

IN SLOW-MO:

- LEWIS looking down full of suspense
- DEE looking nowhere
- MARK, MONICA AND RACHEL holding their breath
- CHRIS in the corridor, with his teammates around that discuss strategy
- JEFF, with the whistle between his teeth and an annoying grin on his face, then...

PHEWWWWWW!!!!!!

The Games have begun.

The students are in a Mexican standoff, no one dares to draw first. The wind lightly waves the flags.

Then a student, the smallest kid on the field, in a yellow bib, starts compulsively sprinting towards the other halve of the field.

He is in the spotlight, it's his moment, if it weren't for a kid in a red bib, who is comically larger and is just as eager to make a name for himself.

The student in the red, tracks him with his eyes. The kid in the yellow doesn't notice him, but we do. He stalks him, like a lion the gazelle. He counts his steps and, as soon as the kid in the yellow enters the red halve, he darts in his direction.

The kid in yellow has just the time to turn to him before that RHINO OF A STUDENT BRUTALLY SPEARS HIM TO THE GROUND.

OOOH.

Jeff whistles and raises his hand. The student in the red laughs over the other, as Jeff helps him out of the field.

JEFF

What are you all looking at? PLAY
THE GAMES!

He whistles again. All hell breaks loose.

Kids running in every direction. Kids being thrown to the ground. Flags behind lifted. Smiles turning into shock turning into pain. And whistles. SO MUCH WHISTLING.

We quickly lose track of the happenings. We see kids exiting and entering the field. Kids trying to carry flags into their half and being shut down. All in a seemingly endless and almost coordinated chaotic convulsion.

EXT. STANDS - SAME TIME

Lewis observes from above. Each fall looks even more brutal from his perspective.

Then...

LEWIS POV: a kid in the red picks up a red flag and heads for his half. He dodges one opponent, jumps over another.

MAN #1

GO! GO!

MAN #2

He's gonna make it.

WOMAN #1

No he's not.

The kid finally eludes one last adversary and enters his side of the field.

The crowd GOES INSANE. They think he made it and he thinks so himself, as he slows his run down to a jog heading for his own end-zone. The only issue, he has forgotten about the new rules. Full-court chases. A teammate tries to warn him, but that Rhino runs into him. He FLIES out of the field.

MAN #1

He can't do that!

MAN #2

REF! WHAT THE FUCK!

The crowd starts booing. Jeff shrugs as The Rhino calmly collects his flag and brings it back to his half, unbothered by others' attempts at bringing him down.

EXT. MONICA'S STAND - CONTINUOUS

There's a bit of a line in front of the stand. Monica, Rachel and Mark work at full steam, when they hear the commotion.

MONICA
(placing two hotdogs on
the counter)
What happened?

COSTUMER #1
He chased him into his own halve.

MONICA
What? Was it sanctioned?

COSTUMER #1
Apparently no.

Rachel arrives with fries. Soon after follows Mark with
onion rings.

MARK
What's going on?

RACHEL
Full-court chases.

MARK
That can't be right.

MONICA
(to the customer)
It will be fifteen.

The customer pays, picks up his food and leaves.

RACHEL
They are gonna get seriously hurt.

Monica frowns.

MONICA
It's gonna be fine.

Monica looks at the queue and shakes the worry away.

MONICA (CONT'D)
HOW MANY DOGS?

Some people raise their hands. She counts them.

MONICA (CONT'D)
BURGERS?

Again, hands and count.

MONICA (CONT'D)
FRIES GOOD FOR EVERYBODY?

Various agreements emerge from the crowd.

MONICA (CONT'D)

Rachel. Fire six hotdogs and seven
burgers. Mark. Fire thirteen fries.

RACHEL

Coming right up.

Rachel leaves for her station. Mark stays there. Monica
starts taking the drink order from the first customer, then
she notices Mark just standing there.

MONICA

Thirteen fries Mark.

MARK

I can go talk to him.

MONICA

What? What are you talking about?

MARK

To Jeff. Tell him to cool it with
the chases.

MONICA

I need thirteen fries, Mark.

MARK

But-

MONICA

If you are not going to help you
can leave.

MARK

Monica.

MONICA

If you are not going to help you
can leave.

Mark heads to the back, disappointed. Monica turns to the
customer.

MONICA (CONT'D)

Just a couple of minutes.

INT. CORRIDOR - SAME TIME

Chris is huddled with his time. We hear the continuous whistling in the background.

DANIEL

Ouch.

JAMES

How the fuck do you take down that guy?

CHRIS

(absently)

You don't.

INT. GAMES FIELD - CONTINUOUS

The Rhino scurries into his own endzone where two other flags are already set.

Jeff takes a long whistles and points to that side of the field, signaling their victory.

The kids hug each other, the crowd boos.

ANNOUNCER (O.C.)

The following two teams please prepare themselves. The Games will continue shortly.

INT. CORRIDOR - CONTINUOUS

There's chatter around Chris who just can seem to focus until...

JAMES

What do you think?

CHRIS

What?

DANIEL

Were you not listening?

CHRIS

It doesn't matter.

JAMES

What do you mean it doesn't matter?
It's The Games.

CHRIS

It's everyday.

EXT. BACK MONICA'S STAND - MOMENTS LATER

Mark walks out agitated and pulls a cigarette out of his pocket.

ROSENTHAL (O.C.)
Trouble in paradise?

Mark doesn't even light the cigarette and throws it to the ground before stepping on it.

Rosenthal walks up to him.

ROSENTHAL (CONT'D)
It's not healthy, you know?

MARK
You are one to talk.

ROSENTHAL
One can know their poison and still
be drawn to it.

MARK
So what are you lecturing me about?

ROSENTHAL
I'm not doing any lecturing.

MARK
That's all you do. Remember what
you told my father? Right before he
died? I was there. I was there when
you looked him in the eye and told
him: "Fix your heart or die". Maybe
that's also a perspective I should
follow. Maybe I should fix my
heart, because guess what? He
didn't and he died.

ROSENTHAL
Mark. There's no need for this.

MARK
Did you even know I was there?

ROSENTHAL
I didn't.

MARK
I actually think you did. I think
that's the point you were trying to
make all along. But it doesn't
matter. You said it and I heard it.

ROSENTHAL

You know how I highly I thought of
your father.

MARK

You say you did, and yet, you stood
there, in his home, with his son
just a couple of feet away and you
looked him in the eye and told him:
"Fix your heart or die". You know
what? Maybe I should listen to you.
Maybe I should fix my heart,
because guess what? He didn't and
he died.

ROSENTHAL

Mark. Are you okay?

Mark smiles bitterly, then looks Rosenthal right in the eye.

MARK

No.

Mark renters the stand.

Rosenthal as she heads back to the crowd, seemingly
disappearing into it right away.

INT. MONICA'S STAND - MOMENTS LATER

Mark enters to see Monica putting up a "CLOSED" sign and
Rachel turning of the friers.

MONICA

(to a customer)

I know. I'm sorry. We are closing
for a moment, we'll be right back.

MARK

What's going on?

MONICA

It's his turn.

MARK

Already?

MONICA

Let's go.

RACHEL

He's going to be okay? You know?
The Games are not what they used to
be.

MONICA

I know. I know. Let's just go.

We stay on them as they exit the stand from the back and approach the side of...

EXT. GAMES FIELD - CONTINUOUS

Chris and his teammates are in the yellow. Chris stands in the front, on the left flank, the further from his mother.

MARK

He seems ready.

MONICA

He is.

RACHEL

GO CHRIS! WOOO!

Chris turns to them, shyly waves then...

PHEWWWW!!! Second Game is underway.

There is no stalemate this time. Chris' team seemingly recoils at first, with all six guys standing at the border of their own end zone, but just before perplexity can even mount on the faces of their opponents, they SIMULTANEOUSLY CHARGE towards the other half.

The red team is caught by surprise. The crowd cheer for their bravery as the yellow team swivels to retrieve the flag in the endzone. Chris gets the central one.

INT. CORRIDOR - CONTINUOUS

Tara fake-halfheartedly observes the scene.

EXT. GAMES FIELD - CONTINUOUS

The yellow team has now all the flags, but they are stuck in the opposing team end zone and they are being circled like shark a sailboat.

Mark attentively observes, then turns to the yellow endzone. Then again to the standoff.

MARK

What's stopping them from just going to get their flags?

CHELSEA

What do you mean?

MARK

Well- they only need three people to guard Chris and the other two. The others can just go, grab the flags and stroll back. Win.

MONICA

What if the moment those three leave to go get the flag, they all sprint out again? Maybe they want them to go get the flags.

MARK

But they would only defend the flag-carriers, if they get them down the others can go and the Game is basically back to square one.

CHELSEA

Can they pass the flag to each other?

MARK

How do you not know this?

MONICA

Mark! Don't be so rude. They can.

MARK

But not when tackled.

MONICA

And they can't throw it.

CHELSEA

How would one even throw a flag?

MONICA

Very dangerously and very stupidly.

Suddenly, PHEWWWW! Jeff blows the whistle and steps right in the field.

Crowd BOOS!

JEFF

Okay guys this is getting ridiculous. Like, great play, but come on.

He fiddles with his watch, we see he is setting a timer for one and a half minutes.

JEFF (CONT'D)

You have until this timer goes off to get out of this situation, otherwise you both lose, I don't care.

CHRIS

You can't do that.

JEFF

I can't do literally whatever I like.

JAMES

How long is the timer?

JEFF

Doesn't matter.

Jeff presses the timer. Countdown starts.

On the other side of the field Monica, Mark and Chelsea observe just as confused as anybody else.

MONICA

What happened there?

JEFF

God only knows with-

CHELSEA

Oh my god.

All the six members of the red team immediately SPRINT to the other endzone.

Yellow team runs behind them.

JEFF

That's what I'm talking about.

EXT. STANDS - CONTINUOUS

LEWIS

What the hell it's going on here.

INT. GAMES FIELD - CONTINUOUS

The red bib Chris is running behind suddenly stops, resulting in Chris crushing at full speed into this guy.

CROWS

OHHHH

As both Chris and the guy collapse to the floor.

MONICA
Jesus!

MARK
It wasn't that bad.

RACHEL
Looked pretty bad.

Mark stared down at her.

IN THE FIELD ALL HELL IS ABOUT TO BREAK LOOSE.

There's a lot of pulling and grabbing and running and being grabbed.

Chris rolls over to the guy.

CHRIS
Are you okay?

GUY #1
I am alive.

A punch is thrown somewhere within the fighting teams.
Another follows. It quickly turns into a full on fight.

The guy next to Chris thinks of stepping up, Chris quickly stops him.

CHRIS
There is no need.

The fight grows in violence. Blood is drawn.

MONICA
Okay, he seems okay.

MARK
Why is he not stopping this?

Mark turns to Jeff, who looks bemused.

The crowd energy keeps going, then is deflated when James is KNOCKED TO THE GROUND BY A RIGHT END.

Silence falls, the kids keep fighting, harder and harder.

Chris, while probably concussed, jumps up to stop the fight.

Tara runs out the corridor onto the field.

Mark runs in the field, a couple of other adults follow.

As soon as he gets in there he pushes Chris aside. He tries to renter but Tara's hands stop him.

Chris turns to Tara, smiles, she smiles back.

MARK (CONT'D)
(managing to calm down
the kids)
Okay. Calm down everybody. It's a
game it's over. Someone get some
ice over to that kid on the ground.

The other parents also take the kids into custody, dwelling the storm. Kids breath heavily, one of them picks up James from the ground.

GUY #2
I'm sorry, dude.

JAMES
It fucking hurts.

Looking around, Mark realizes Jeff is not there, he is still on the other side of the field.

His attentions shifts entirely to him, laser focused.

He strides towards him, fuming.

RACHEL
What's he doing?

MONICA
I don't know but I don't like it.

She starts walking in his direction.

MARK
You piece of shit! You disgusting
piece of shit!

Crowd gasps.

MONICA
MARK NO! PLEASE!

Mark arrives right in front of Jeff, who smugly smiles at him.

JEFF
What do you think you are do-

Mark clocks him right in the jaw, Jeff falls right down.

MONICA

MARK! WHAT THE FUCK!

Mark turns around, sees Monica's face, sees all the faces, all the gratuitous violence, and rapidly heads for the corridor.

No one follows him.

(CONT'D)